

PHISHING EMAIL DETECTION & AWARENESS REPORT

Cyber Security Internship – Future Interns

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1. Introduction

This report presents an analysis of phishing emails and highlights common indicators used in phishing and social engineering attacks. The objective is to improve cybersecurity awareness and help users identify suspicious emails.

2. Objectives

- Identify phishing indicators in suspicious emails.
- Analyze malicious email characteristics.
- Classify emails as phishing or legitimate.
- Provide cybersecurity awareness and prevention methods.

3. Common Phishing Indicators

Indicator	Description
Fake Sender Address	Spoofed or suspicious email domain
Urgency	Pressures users to act immediately
Suspicious Links	Redirects to fake or malicious websites
Grammar Errors	Poor spelling or formatting
Free Rewards	Used as social engineering bait

4. Email 1 Analysis – Coca-Cola Reward Scam

Classification	Phishing Email
Risk Level	Medium
Threat Type	Social Engineering
Status	Analyzed

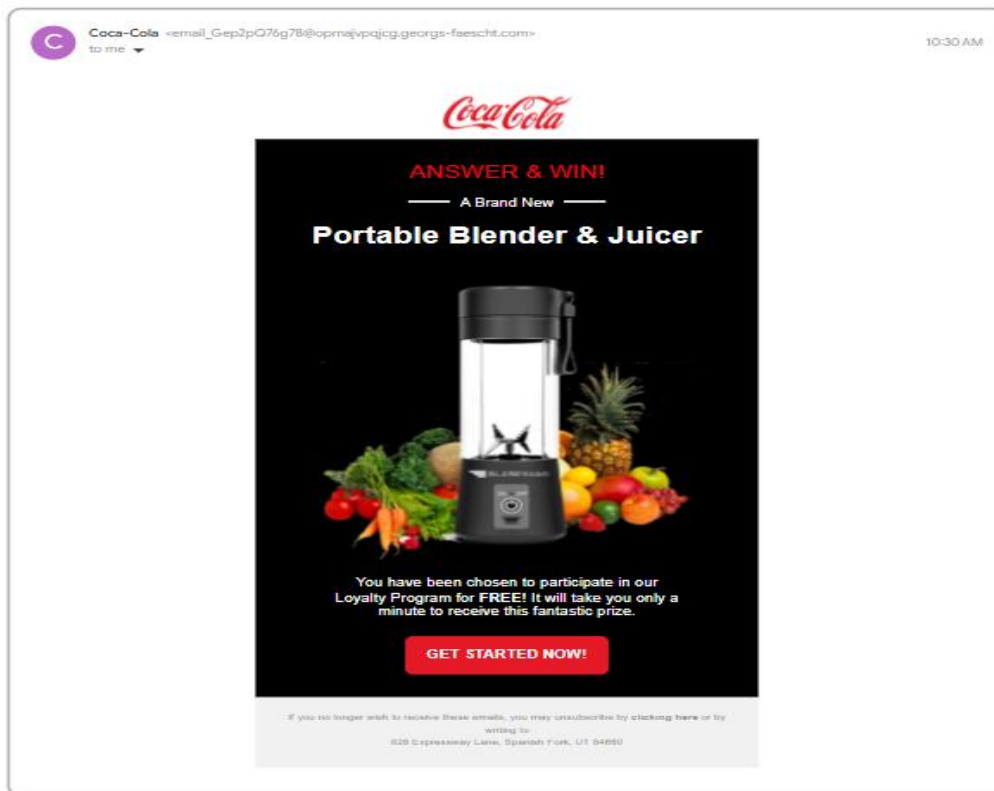


Figure 1: Suspicious Coca-Cola promotional reward email.

Analysis

The email uses a trusted brand name and free reward offers to manipulate users into clicking malicious links. The sender address appears suspicious and the message uses urgency techniques.

Recommendation

Users should verify promotional offers through official websites and avoid clicking unknown links.

5. Email 2 Analysis – Fake PayPal Invoice

Classification	Phishing Email
Risk Level	High
Threat Type	Financial Fraud
Status	Analyzed

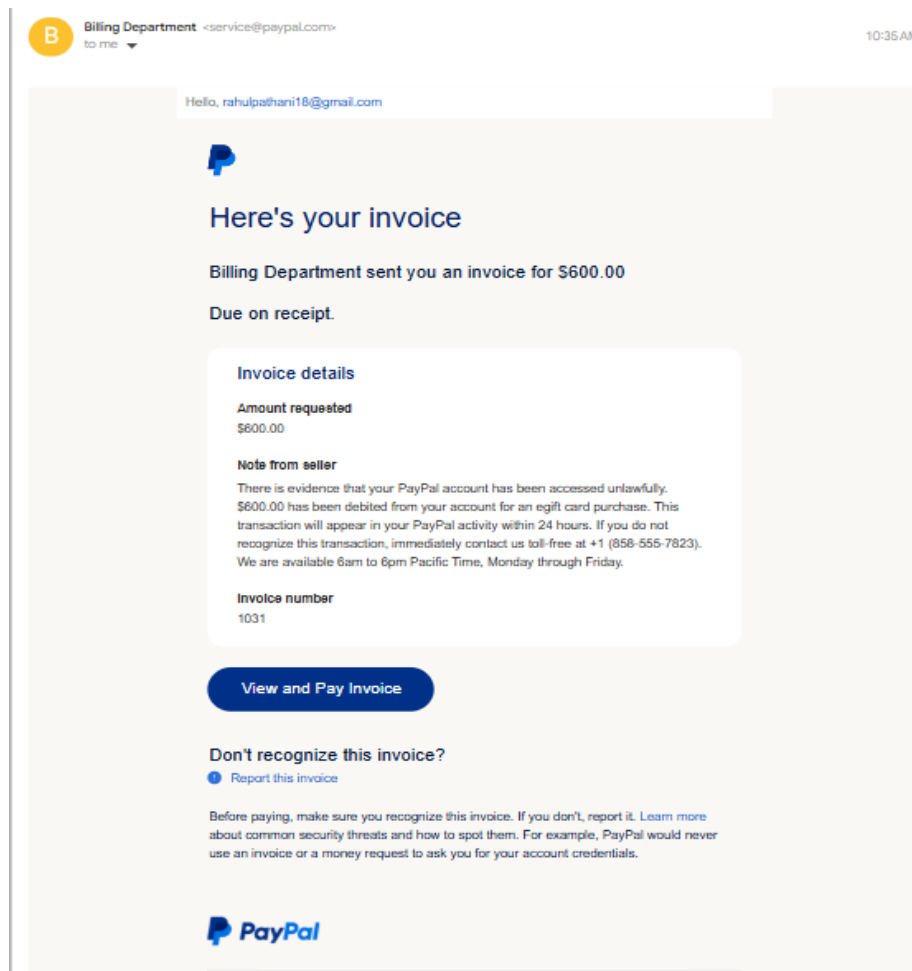


Figure 2: Fake PayPal invoice phishing email.

Analysis

The email attempts to scare users by mentioning unauthorized account access and fake invoice payments. Attackers commonly use fear tactics to manipulate victims into sending money or revealing credentials.

Recommendation

Users should verify invoices directly from official PayPal websites and avoid suspicious support numbers.

6. Email 3 Analysis – Legitimate Dropbox Notification

Classification	Safe / Legitimate Email
Risk Level	Low
Threat Type	Informational Notification
Status	Analyzed

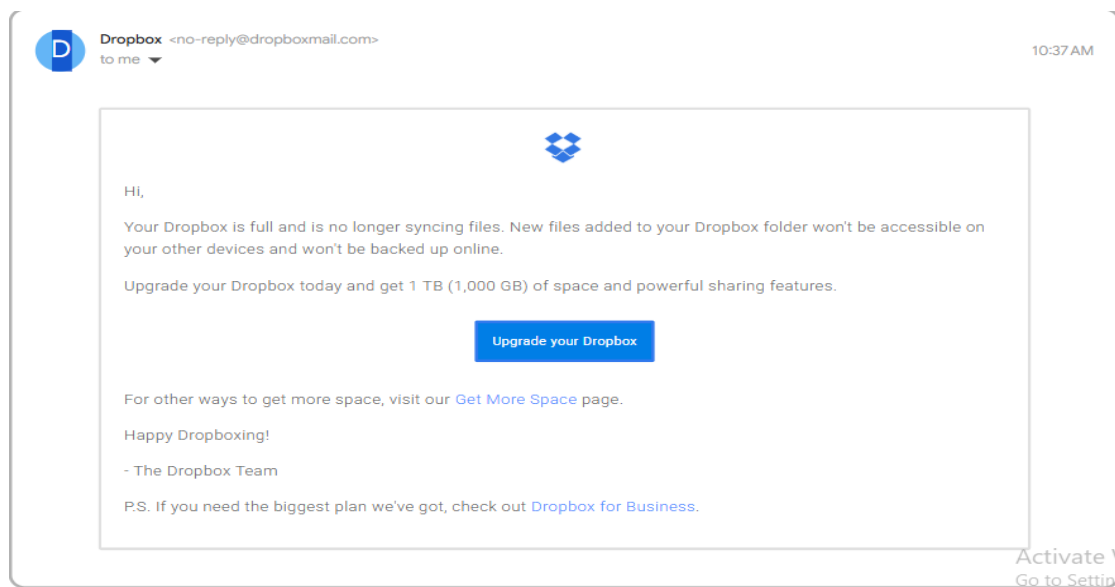


Figure 3: Legitimate Dropbox notification email.

Analysis

The email appears legitimate because it uses professional formatting, official branding, and an authentic sender domain.

Recommendation

Users should still verify sender domains and avoid unknown attachments or links.

7. Prevention Guidelines

- Verify sender email addresses carefully.
- Avoid clicking suspicious or shortened links.
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- Avoid downloading unknown attachments.
- Use updated antivirus and spam filtering tools.
- Report suspicious emails immediately.

8. Conclusion

Phishing attacks rely on social engineering techniques to manipulate users into revealing sensitive information or performing harmful actions. Understanding phishing indicators and practicing careful email verification are essential cybersecurity habits.